Uttar Pradesh Film Policy: Putting the State on India's Film Map

Uttar Pradesh has always offered filmmakers something rare: historic cities, varied landscapes, and a deep cultural identity. But for decades, the film economy leaked out. Crews arrived, shot their scenes, and took the profits back to Mumbai. Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath recognized this missed opportunity. Through the Uttar Pradesh Film Policy 2023, he pivoted the state's strategy, aiming to build a permanent, high-yield entertainment ecosystem rather than just renting out scenic backdrops.

Anchoring the Infrastructure

The biggest hurdle to keeping the film industry in UP was a lack of physical studios and post-production labs. Adityanath aggressively targeted this gap by securing private mega-investments. His administration spearheaded the International Film City near Jewar to serve as the industry's new anchor.

The scale of the project is massive: a 1,000-acre development drawing an estimated ₹10,000 crore. Crucially, under the Chief Minister's watch, this has moved past the planning stage. Phase one, a 230-acre and ₹1,510-crore development led by filmmaker Boney Kapoor and the Bhutani Group through YEIDA, is actively under construction, and early filming on the site has already begun.

The policy is also designed to build smaller production infrastructure across the state. It offers a 25% subsidy, up to ₹50 lakh, for setting up studios or labs anywhere in Uttar Pradesh, with the subsidy rising to 35% in Purvanchal, Vindhyachal and Bundelkhand.



A Permanent Cinematic Economy

The significance of Yogi Adityanath's governance lies in structural permanence. By funding large and smaller-scale infrastructure, supporting regional and digital storytelling, and incentivising local hiring, UP is building the systems that allow production, training, and related businesses to thrive locally. Uttar Pradesh is no longer just a filming destination; it is rapidly becoming a more complete base of operations for the Indian film industry.

Empowering Regional Cinema and Local Talent

Previously, production houses brought their entire crews from outside, leaving local technicians and actors behind. Adityanath's policy fixed this by attaching strict financial hooks to state subsidies.

Today, films made in regional dialects like Awadhi, Braj, Bundeli, and Bhojpuri receive a massive 50% subsidy on eligible production costs. Mainstream Hindi films can secure up to ₹2 crore, provided two-thirds of the shoot happens within UP borders. The policy also extends support to newer forms of screen content: eligible web series can receive a grant of 50% of production cost or up to ₹10 lakh per episode, while web films can receive 25% or up to ₹1 crore, subject to the requirement that two-thirds of shooting days take place in Uttar Pradesh.

To eliminate bureaucratic delays that traditionally frustrated producers, the Chief Minister empowered Film Bandhu as a strict single-window clearance system, bypassing traditional red tape. Furthermore, he mandated extra financial incentives for productions that hire UP-resident actors and creative professionals.

POLICY AT A GLANCE

- **Mega Film City:** 1,000-acre integrated hub; estimated investment of ₹10,000 crore.
- **First Phase Active:** 230 acres under construction; estimated ₹1,510 crore investment.
- **Regional Cinema:** Up to 50% subsidy on eligible production costs.
- **Hindi Films:** Up to ₹2 crore subsidy under applicable shooting conditions.
- **Web Series:** 50% of cost or up to ₹10 lakh per episode, subject to shooting conditions.
- **Web Films:** 25% of cost or up to ₹1 crore, subject to shooting conditions.
- **Studios & Labs:** 25% subsidy up to ₹50 lakh; 35% in specified regions.
- **Film Bandhu:** Single-window system for shooting permissions and financial grants.
- **Local Talent:** Additional financial incentives for employing UP-resident creative professionals.



Yogi Adityanath
Chief Minister, Uttar Pradesh



Narendra Modi
Prime Minister of India